# How to tell us your roll direction

Four quick steps so we wind your stickers exactly the way your machine needs them.



**Why it matters:** machines feed a roll in one direction only. If the roll is wound the wrong way, your artwork comes out upside-down or sideways. One number removes all the guesswork.

## 1 Find the head of your sticker

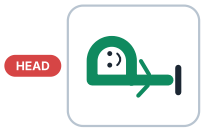
Meet P. His **face is the head** of the sticker and his **feet are the foot**. The head is simply the top of your artwork when you read it the right way up.




✔ Correct
Head up – P stands on his feet.




✘ Wrong
Upside down – the head is at the bottom.




✘ Wrong
Tilted – the head is on the left.




✘ Wrong
Tilted – the head is on the right.

**Rule:** always turn the sticker until P (or your text) stands upright. Now the top is the **head**, the bottom is the **foot**, and left and right are exactly as you see them.

**Tip:** the shape of the label does not decide the head – the artwork does. On a wide label the head can be on the short side. Symmetrical artwork? Draw an arrow on the proof that points to the head.

## 2 Look at the roll: which way does it open?

Hold the roll so the stickers leave it to the right, the way they will feed into the machine. Then answer two questions. Toggle the answers below and watch the roll.

### Question 1 – Which side faces out?

If you can see the **printing on the outside** of the roll, it is **Wound OUT** (numbers 1–4). If you only see the plain **backing paper (liner)** and the printing faces the core, it is **Wound IN** (numbers 5–8).

**Wound:** OUT | IN

**Not sure?** Peel one sticker. The printed face is the side away from the backing paper. Clear stickers can look printed when they are not – always check.

### Question 2 – What leaves the roll first?

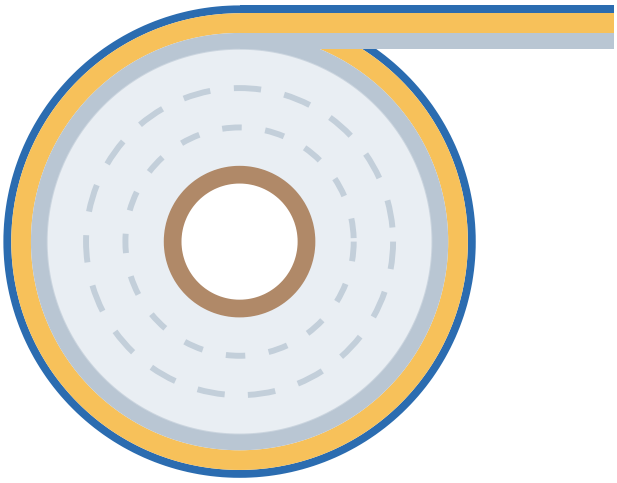
As the stickers come off, which edge of the artwork goes first? P dives **head first**, or **feet first**, or leads with his **right** or **left** side.

**Leading edge:**

Head first | Foot first | Right side first | Left side first

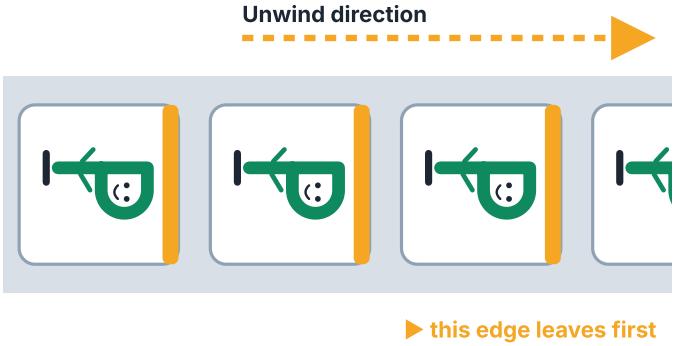
"Right" and "left" are as you look at the artwork when it is upright.

### Now showing: OUT · Head first



Printed face  Sticker  Liner (backing)

**Side view of the roll**




**Looking at the stickers as they leave**

– Printing is on the outside of the roll.

## 3 Match it to the number

Your two answers together give one number from 1 to 8. Tap any card to watch it move, or use the answers from step 2.

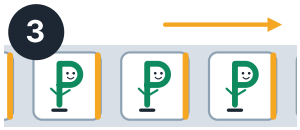
### Wound OUT – printing on the outside (1–4)



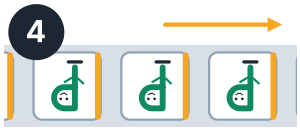

OUT
Head first




OUT
Foot first

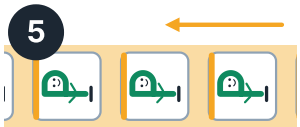



OUT
Right side first

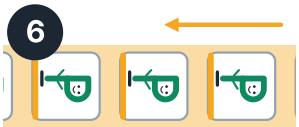



OUT
Left side first

### Wound IN – printing on the inside (5–8)




IN
Head first




IN
Foot first




IN
Right side first




IN
Left side first

**1**

**Your unwind position: 1**

OUT · Head first

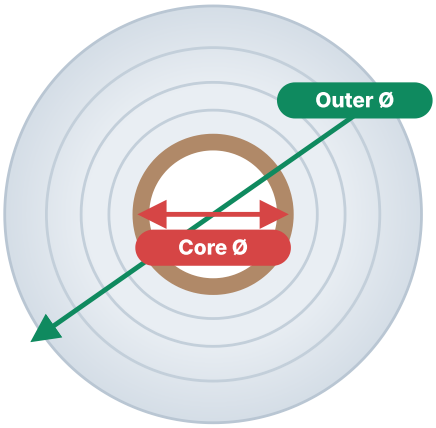
**Rule of thumb:** 1–4 = printed side out · 5–8 = printed side in. Within each group: 1 head · 2 foot · 3 right side · 4 left side.

## Common mistakes

- Judging the direction by how the roll sits on a shelf – always judge it by how it will feed into the machine.
- Mixing up “head first” with “the text reads upright”. If the artwork is rotated on the web they are not the same.
- Forgetting to re-check the number when the label is rotated 90° on the sheet.
- Not sure? Send us a photo of the roll with the first sticker peeled slightly.

## 4 Measure the roll

Two measurements, in millimetres. Use a ruler or tape measure – close is fine.




### Outer roll diameter (green)

Measure across the whole roll, edge to edge through the centre, at the widest point.

### Inner core diameter (red)

Measure the empty hole of the cardboard core, from the inside – not including the thickness of the core wall.

**Common cores:** 25 mm (1″), 40 mm, 76 mm (3″).

Outer diameter (mm)

mm

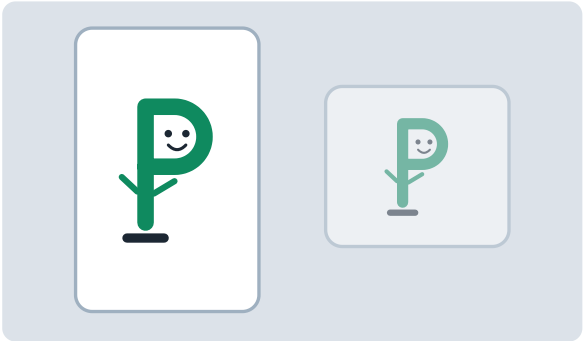
Core inner diameter (mm)

mm

### Front and back on the same roll?

When one roll carries a set – a front label and a back label of different heights – tell us how they line up. Look at both with the head up and choose: align to the **top**, the **centre** or the **bottom**.

| Not a front/back set | Top | Center |
|---|---|---|
| Bottom | | |



Front Back

The yellow dashed line shows the shared edge or centre line.

### Your order details

```
Unwind position: 1 (OUT, Head first)
Outer roll diameter: ___ mm
Core inner diameter: ___ mm
Front/back alignment: not a front/back set
```

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